IVAN ZHUKOV

FINTECH DATA & ANALYTICS LEADER

Data Products | Decisioning | External Data & Enrichment | Applied Machine Learning | Commercial Optimisation

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PROFILE

Fintech data and analytics leader with 10+ years of experience across fintech and banking. Combines hands-on expertise in SQL, Python and applied machine learning with leadership of analytics teams and ownership of decisioning, scoring, external-data enrichment, customer-acquisition and commercial-optimisation products across the full product lifecycle. Experienced in defining product hypotheses and success metrics, directing analytical and machine-learning development, validating pilots, coordinating production rollout and translating model performance into measurable commercial outcomes.

SELECTED IMPACT

- Led the analytical design and evolution of TakeUp, a personalised lender-offer ranking and allocation product for financial marketplace websites, replacing manually configured offer placement with data-driven decisioning. TakeUp achieved an 11.1% revenue uplift against the previous ranking logic on comparable traffic, while estimated incremental revenue across its wider deployment averaged approximately £75,000 per month.
- Designed and validated an ML-based communication-suppression model and coordinated its production rollout, saving approximately £36,000 per month in communication costs across all business users without materially reducing valuable customer traffic.
- Led the analytical design and scaling of a reusable Spark-based transformation component that converted communication-event data into structured behavioural features for client scoring and lead-generation projects. The component enabled 45 new production pipelines and supported the expansion of the lead-generation business, whose client base grew from 13 to 30 organisations and annual revenue increased from approximately £6,5 million to £10 million.
- Lead a team of five analysts delivering production decisioning and applied machine-learning initiatives, including a visit-level website bot-detection model that reduced the number of bot and noisy visits included in reporting by approximately 50%, making EPC, EPV and conversion metrics more representative of genuine user activity.

PROFESSIONAL DIGITAL TECHNOLOGY EXPERIENCE

IT-FINANCE — **Remote / Russia | Jun 2024 - Present**

Data Analyst Team Lead | Feb 2025 - Present

Data Analyst | Jun 2024 - Feb 2025

A fintech-focused software company developing proprietary products for data-driven decisioning, scoring, external-data enrichment, communications and customer acquisition, serving banks, consumer lenders and financial marketplaces.

- Lead a five-person analytics team delivering product analytics, data products, scoring solutions and applied machine-learning projects; set priorities, define analytical approaches, allocate work, review methodology and code, and oversee delivery from problem definition and validation through pilots and, where applicable, production rollout.
- Own the analytical direction across the team's portfolio while personally leading the analytical design of key data products; define business hypotheses, data requirements and success metrics, coordinate implementation with engineering and commercial teams, and assess post-launch performance.
- Led the analytical development and ongoing evolution of TakeUp, a personalised lender-offer ranking and allocation system for financial marketplace websites, combining commercial performance, credit-risk signals and observed rejection and issuance outcomes at website, traffic-source and customer-segment level. TakeUp became a core component of WebEngine, the company's main product platform.
- Replaced manually configured offer placement with data-driven ranking and allocation. TakeUp achieved an 11.1% revenue uplift and generated an estimated combined financial impact of approximately £75,000 per month
- Designed and validated an ML-based communication-suppression model and coordinated its production rollout, reducing aggregate communication costs by approximately 2% and saving around £36,000 per month across all business users without materially affecting valuable customer traffic.
- Set the analytical direction for applied machine-learning projects including time-series demand forecasting, bot detection based on visit-level behaviour, customer classification, NLP-based structuring of third-party item-level data, and an AI agent proof of concept applied to TakeUp and analytical workflows.
- Directed retrospective and out-of-time validation of external credit-risk and behavioural models, assessing AUC/Gini, segment-level performance, incremental coverage, cannibalisation and cross-source overlap for new data sources. Designed cost-optimised external-scoring cascade logic and PD-based risk-decision hooks, prioritising lower-cost telecom scores before credit-bureau scores where performance, coverage and risk thresholds allowed.
- Initiated and led the analytical development of the Enrichment Service, guiding the team from R&D and validation through to production integration. Designed and validated the analytical logic for an exclusive-client segmentation flag, identifying negative-margin traffic with an estimated monthly cost-revenue gap of up to £15,000 for one business user.
- Defined data-mart requirements and developed reusable SQL/Python datasets, data-quality checks and Streamlit reporting tools for acquisition, communication, conversion and monetisation analytics.

ONEFACTOR — **Moscow, Russia | Jan 2021 - Feb 2024**

Lead Data Analyst / Product Manager, B2B Fintech Products

A B2B fintech company providing external-data enrichment, scoring, lead-generation and customer-intelligence products to banks, consumer lenders, insurers and financial marketplaces.

- Led the product and analytical development of a reusable Spark-based transformation component and scaled it in production, converting pseudonymised communication events into behavioural features for scoring, customer segmentation and lead generation.

- Owned the product logic behind the component: defined the event taxonomy, sender and message classification rules, aggregation windows, thresholds and output specifications, and worked with data engineering teams to implement and scale it in production.
- Redesigned signal selection, audience generation and data processing around the reusable component, launching 45 new production pipelines and standardising behavioural feature generation across client scoring and lead-generation products. This work supported portfolio expansion during a period when the client base grew from 13 to 30 organisations and annual revenue increased from approximately £6,5 million to £10 million.
- Designed and delivered more than 30 client-specific pilots and validation studies covering data coverage, customer matching, scoring performance, lead quality, conversion funnels and campaign economics. Used the findings to recommend product configurations and support go/no-go and production decisions.
- Supported product development, pre-sales and client delivery by presenting data coverage, analytical methodology, validation results and expected commercial performance to product, commercial and client teams.
- Developed segment-specific communication logic, including 16 new communication scenarios, contributing to an approximately 3% improvement in conversion.

FINANCE SECTOR EXPERIENCE

OPEN BANK **Moscow, Russia | Sep 2019 - Jan 2021**

Lead Data Analyst in Risk Department

One of the top 10 largest banks in Russia.

- Identified and rectified a critical error in the credit decisioning system within the CRM integration, restoring services for 110,000 clients and contributing to an approximate financial recovery of £2,3 million over six months.
- Led a risk-analytics workstream covering credit decisioning, credit-bureau event triggers and their application in customer risk assessment.
- Developed and tested guidance for the PACL credit decisioning process, expediting client approvals and offers. Collaboration with IT and technology teams accelerated analysis and ensured swift client-batch approvals.
- Devised a revenue calculation method based on peak debt load, reducing gross loss risk by 0.4% for clients with low credit scores while accounting for full and partial loan repayments.
- Conducted research on internal fraud within bank offices, uncovering six suspicious activities and prompting internal audits that strengthened control mechanisms and security.
- Mentored and trained graduate Data Analyst interns in SQL, analytical methods and banking business processes.

RENAISSANCE INSURANCE **Moscow, Russia | Aug 2018 - Aug 2019**

A leading Russian insurance company providing a full range of auto, property and health insurance services.

Data Analyst in CRM Department

- Automated call-centre list preparation in collaboration with the Digital Insurance department using SQL scripts, reducing preparation time from 1.5 weeks to four days.
- Developed four SSRS reports for the Digital Insurance division, including sales-funnel diagrams and tables, and worked with IT to resolve errors and streamline reporting procedures.

ALFA BANK **Moscow, Russia | Dec 2017 - Aug 2018**

One of the top 10 banks in Russia and a pioneer in innovative technological solutions in the Russian financial sector.

Data Analyst in Finance Department, CIB

- Delivered an automated ROI calculator for individual CIB clients and segments, implementing the approved methodology in SQL and streamlining recurring calculations and portfolio assessments.
- Managed workload assessments for CIB Salesforce managers in collaboration with HR, building an SSRS report with daily updates and recommendations to optimise workforce efficiency.

ZENIT BANK **Moscow, Russia | Oct 2016 - Dec 2017**

Regional bank with a strong position in private banking, servicing both individuals and businesses.

Data Analyst in the Department of SME Analytics and Forecasting

- Implemented an automated system to calculate incentive bonuses for acquisition and relationship managers based on workloads, reducing calculation time from one day to several hours.
- Collaborated on competitor analysis for financial products, supporting sales productivity and the bank's competitiveness in the market.

RUSSIAN RAILWAYS **Moscow, Russia | Mar 2015 - Oct 2016**

Russia's largest suburban passenger carrier, with an 80% market share in Moscow's railway hub and 60% nationwide.

Data Analyst in Passenger Transportation Analysis Department

CORE EXPERTISE

Fintech data products • Analytics leadership • Decisioning and optimisation • External data and enrichment • Credit scoring and risk analytics • Product and commercial analytics • Customer acquisition • Applied machine learning • Experimentation • Production monitoring • Data warehousing • Cross-functional delivery

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming & Data Processing: Python, SQL, Pandas, Apache Spark, PySpark, Greenplum, Impala

Machine Learning, Ranking & NLP: CatBoost, LightGBM, XGBoost, DeepFM, multi-armed bandits, predictive modelling, classification, feature engineering, BERT-based NLP, model validation

Data Engineering & MLOps: Airflow, dbt, MLflow, automated data pipelines, ML experiment tracking, model performance monitoring, data quality monitoring

EDUCATION

BAUMAN MOSCOW STATE TECHNICAL UNIVERSITY

- University Degree in Industrial Management (Russian Specialist Diploma)
- University Degree in Nuclear Power Engineering (Russian Specialist Diploma)

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Languages: Russian (native), English (C1), German (A2)

Contributor to: TAdviser, CNews, IT-World, IT Channel News, HackerNoon etc.